Indian Institute of Management Calcutta

MK253: Relationship Marketing (RM)
Course Credits 3; MBA62; AY 2026-27; Elective Course (Term VI)

INSTRUCTOR:
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INTRODUCTION

The objective of this course is to provide an understanding of relational exchange in the business context. The objectives of this course are:

- To offer an understanding of the nature of business relationships and the domain of Relationship Marketing,
- To integrate an understanding of concepts and issues that are under the purview of Relationship Marketing and are dealt with in the practice of CRM, such as customer value, customer satisfaction, customer expectation, customer delight, memorable buying experience, Customer Lifetime Value, etc.

COURSE PEDAGOGY

Each classroom session will be a combination of lecture, discussions based on cases and readings, and in-class activities. The stress on a component may differ in different sessions, with some component(s) being absent in certain sessions.

COURSE MATERIAL

Readings, cases, and textbook chapters will be provided as part of the course-pack.
Reference Texts are listed below:

1) "*Customer Relationship Management: A Databased Approach*", V Kumar, & WJ Reinartz, Wiley India Edition, New Delhi, 1999
2) "*Customer Relationship Management: Concepts, Strategy, and Tools*", V Kumar, & WJ Reinartz, Springer-Verlag, Second Edition, Berlin, 2018 (hereafter referred to as **Kumar & Reinartz, 2018)**
3) "*Customer Relationship Management*", G Shainesh & J Sheth, Macmillan Publishers India Ltd., 2006

COURSE EVALUATION

Student evaluation for this course will have the following components:

1)	Class Participation	20%
2)	Assignments (Group) (2 Nos.)	30%
3)	Quizzes (Announced) (5 Nos.)	50%

Assignments (Group)

- *Assignment 1*: Data Mining Exercise - maximize Profitability of the firm.
- *Assignment 2*: Simulation game - maximize Market Valuation and Customer Equity of the firm.

PROPOSED LIST OF TOPICS

Module I: Fundamental Concepts PART I
- Foundations of Relationship Marketing.
- Evolution and growth of CRM. Importance of CRM in today's world.
- Understanding the concept of value in a relational setting.
- Understand the customer satisfaction concept and its relationship with CRM. Appreciate the systems and processes that lead to sustainable customer satisfaction.

Module II: CRM Metrics
- Traditional metrics and customer–based metrics
- RFM, CLV and the role in strategy development
- Word of Mouth and Influence

Module III: Fundamental Concepts PART II
- Customer Acquisition Strategies.
- Resource Allocation for Customer Acquisition and Retention.
- Customer Loyalty and its connection with CRM metrics.

Module IV: CRM in Business and Consumer Markets
- Relationships in the B2B context and dynamics of intra and inter-organizational relationships.
- Leveraging partnerships with intermediaries to create superior value.
- Integrating channels for customer value creation and delivery.
- Managing multichannel shoppers and channel conflict.
- Customer classification and value-based management of customers.
- Structuring and managing loyalty programmes.
- Understanding the link between databases, data mining, and relationship strategy.

Module V: Course Wrap Up
- Problems and pitfalls associated with CRM.
- CRM practice in today's world.

PLEASE NOTE:
1. *You need to have "B Only" or higher grade in **both** Marketing courses (MK101 and MK102) offered in MBA first year to opt for this elective course.*
2. *Students are required to form teams of five (05) members for the group activity prior to commencement of the course. To facilitate this, the final list of students will be shared with those enrolled for the course once it is available from the MBA Office.*

EXPECTATIONS, GUIDELINES & PRACTICES:
Listed below are the expectations of participants, and some general guidelines and practices to be followed for this course. These may be added to or modified during the course to enable smooth conduct of the course.

1) It is expected that students will,
   a. read prescribed material for a session,
   b. contribute positively to all in-class activities (including discussions, presentations etc.), and to their group in group activities,
   c. be honest during quizzes, and submit original work for all submissions, whether these are individual or group submissions,
   d. maintain a level of in-class decorum befitting students of our institution.
2) In the event of academic misdemeanor, malpractice, or misconduct; including submitting plagiarized, purchased, contracted, falsified assignments, submissions, or projects, and cheating

in a quiz or the exam; the relevant MBA rules will apply. The minimum penalty will be a grade of zero on that submitted material, quiz, or exam.

3) Peer-evaluation may be used for Group activities. Peer evaluation may be used either as part or whole of the evaluation and may be used for one or more group assignment/submission.
4) Differently-abled students may freely approach the instructor about any accommodations that they may require. The instructor will make all permissible accommodations with the advice of the MBA Office.
